

LIWELILE IMPUMELELO COMMUNITY CENTRE

JAPAN PARTNERSHIP – OUTREACH EMAIL TEMPLATE

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Prepared by: International Partnerships Coordinator

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SECTION A: MASTER OUTREACH EMAIL TEMPLATE

To: [_____]

Cc: Mzolisi Malusi

Subject: Partnership Opportunity: [Specific Focus – e.g., Animation / Creative Industries] – South African Community Organisation

Date: [_____]

Dear [Mr./Ms. Name / Sir/Madam],

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing from **Liwelile Impumelelo Community Centre**, a registered non-profit organisation (NPO 167-542) based in Germiston, South Africa, serving vulnerable communities in the informal settlements of Marathon and Ramaphosa.

About Us

After nine years of voluntary community service, we have recently established a **multi-purpose community campus** at 22 Fox Glove Avenue, Primrose, delivering **five integrated programmes** that address hunger, isolation, unemployment, and youth development. Our vision extends beyond service delivery into **creative industries and skills development** that will enable our youth to tell South African stories to the world.

Why We Are Reaching Out

We are developing a **Skills Development Programme (Programme 4)** with a specific track focused on **animation, storytelling, and content creation**, inspired by Japan's world-renowned expertise in these fields. Our goal is not just training – it is **skills transfer, cultural exchange, and lasting partnership** that will enable our community to:

- Develop authentic South African animated content

- Preserve and share our rich cultural heritage through modern media
- Create employment pathways for youth in the creative industries
- Build a sustainable creative industry from the ground up

Why [Studio/Organisation Name]

We have identified [Studio/Organisation Name] as a potential partner because:

- [Specific reason 1 – "your TAIDO Project's mission to nurture original African content aligns perfectly with our vision"]
- [Specific reason 2 – "your work on Afro-anime productions demonstrates genuine commitment to African stories"]
- [Specific reason 3 – "your success in co-producing with African partners (AnimaxFYB, Comic Republic) is exactly the model we hope to learn from"]
- [Specific reason 4 – "your expressed interest in South African creative collaboration (as noted in 2018) encourages us to reach out"]

What We Are Seeking

We would be honoured to explore a partnership that could include:

Area	Description
Skills Transfer	Opportunities for our members to learn from your expertise – through workshops, mentorship, or training programmes
Co-Production Possibilities	Collaboration on projects that tell South African stories with Japanese technical support
Creative Exchange	Mutual learning between Japanese and South African storytellers
Youth Engagement	Connecting our youth programmes to animation as a pathway to creative careers
Cultural Preservation	Using animation to document and share South African heritage

What We Offer in Return

Asset	Value to Partner
Authentic South African Stories	Rich cultural narratives waiting to be told – our history, our heroes, our voices
Community Connection	Direct link to youth and community members passionate about creative expression
Demonstration Site	Visible showcase of your commitment to developing African creative talent
Local Knowledge	Understanding of South African audiences and cultural context
Commitment	Serious, organised partner with professional governance and financial systems

Next Steps

I would be grateful for the opportunity to:

1. Introduce our organisation more fully (I have attached our **International Partnership Strategy** and **Skills Development Programme Proposal**)
2. Arrange a virtual meeting to discuss potential collaboration
3. Explore how we might align with your existing Africa-focused initiatives

Thank you for considering this request. I believe there is real potential for a partnership that benefits both our community and your organisation's commitment to nurturing creative talent globally.

I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours faithfully,

Mzolisi Malusi

Chairperson

Liwelile Impumelelo Community Centre

NPO 167-542

076 876 6612 | mzolisimalusi@gmail.com

22 Fox Glove Avenue, Primrose, Germiston, 1401

South Africa

Attachments:

- LICC_International_Partnership_Strategy.pdf
- LICC_Skills_Development_Programme_Proposal.pdf

SECTION B: CUSTOMISATION NOTES BY TARGET

B1: For Arc & Beyond / TAIDO Project (Miyuki Kitabatake)

Element	Customisation
Subject	Partnership Opportunity: South African Stories for TAIDO Project
Why [Organisation]	"We have followed the TAIDO Project with great admiration. Your mission to nurture original African content – created by Africans, with Africans retaining 100% IP ownership – aligns perfectly with our vision. We were particularly inspired by your statement: 'We don't want to make Japanese-style animation. We want to support authentic African stories, created by African studios.'"
Specific Alignment	"Like your partners AnimaxFYB in Ghana and Comic Republic in Nigeria, we believe South Africa has rich, untold stories that deserve to be told through world-class animation. Our community's history, heroes, and heritage are waiting to be shared."
Specific Ask	"We would be honoured to explore how LICC might participate in the TAIDO Project's mentorship or skills transfer programmes. We are eager to learn from your expertise and build the capacity to tell South African stories authentically."
Reference Point	Mention Megumi Okawa's (One Piece production manager) involvement as inspiring

B2: For AnimaxFYB Studios (Francis Brown)

Element	Customisation
Subject	Learning from Your Journey – South African Organisation Seeking Animation Partnership
Why [Organisation]	"As fellow Africans (Ghana and South Africa), we have followed your journey with the TAIDO Project and Arc & Beyond with great interest. Your words – 'Africa contributed \$15.5 billion to global animation market, yet none stayed here because we were only consuming' – resonate deeply with our mission."
Specific Alignment	"We are building an animation track within our Skills Development Programme and dream of doing for South Africa what you are doing for Ghana – creating authentic African content with global reach."
Specific Ask	"We would be deeply grateful for any guidance you could offer – perhaps a brief virtual meeting to share lessons learned from your partnership with Japanese studios, and advice for a South African organisation just starting this journey."
Peer Connection	Position as fellow African organisation, not as supplicant

B3: For Pambili Media (Mandela Dube)

Element	Customisation
Subject	Learning from Your Toei Partnership – South African Creative Collaboration
Why [Organisation]	"We were thrilled to learn about your partnership with Toei Animation on 'Yasuke: Butterfly's Path.' As a South African organisation building an animation track, your success in co-producing with one of Japan's largest studios is exactly the model we aspire to."

Element	Customisation
Specific Alignment	"Your work connecting untold African history with Japanese creative expertise embodies what we hope to achieve – telling South African stories to the world through world-class animation."
Specific Ask	"We would be honoured to learn from your experience – perhaps a brief meeting to understand how you navigated the partnership with Toei, and any advice you might have for organisations like ours just beginning this journey."
Local Connection	Emphasise shared South African context – you are both operating in the same creative landscape

B4: For N LITE (Christiano Terry)

Element	Customisation
Subject	Partnership Opportunity: South African Stories for Afro-Anime (AFRIME)
Why [Organisation]	"Your mission to create 'Afro-anime' (AFRIME) and your tagline 'Japanese Art, brewed in an African Pot' resonate deeply with our vision. We were particularly inspired by your work on 'Chiure: Child of the Sea' with South African studio LUCAN, and the incredible creative team assembled for 'MFINDA.'"
Specific Alignment	"We share your belief that African stories deserve to be told through world-class animation, with African creators at the heart of the creative process. South Africa has rich cultural narratives waiting to be shared."

Element	Customisation
Specific Ask	"We would be honoured to explore how LICC might collaborate with N LITE – whether through skills transfer, co-production opportunities, or connecting you with South African creative talent. Your existing partnership with LUCAN gives us hope that similar collaboration is possible."
Reference Point	Mention "Chiure" partnership with South African studio LUCAN as proof of concept

B5: For Polygon Pictures (Shuzo John Shiota)

Element	Customisation
Subject	Following Up on Your 2018 Interest in South African Partnership
Why [Organisation]	"We recently came across your 2018 statement expressing interest in South African creative collaboration: 'A possible fusion of distinct creative cultures such as that of Japan and South Africa may be able to create an innovative style. The originality that the South African design and sensibilities bring forth, may be able to complement our creative endeavours.'"
Specific Alignment	"Your words have stayed with us. As a South African community organisation building an animation track, we believe the time is right to explore exactly that fusion."
Specific Ask	"We would be grateful to learn whether your interest in South African partnership remains, and if so, to explore how we might begin a conversation."
Timing	Acknowledge the time gap but frame as "your vision was ahead of its time; perhaps now the time is right"

B6: For JETRO Johannesburg (Ruan Botha)

Element	Customisation
Subject	Introduction: South African NPO Seeking Japan Creative Industry Partnership
Why [Organisation]	"We understand that JETRO plays a vital role in connecting South African businesses with Japanese companies, particularly in the creative industries through your partnership with Comic Con Africa and the Japan Pop Culture Connect events."
Specific Alignment	"We are developing an animation track within our Skills Development Programme and are eager to connect with Japanese studios and creative organisations. Your track record of facilitating 75+ meetings and 32 success cases gives us confidence that JETRO is the right place to start."
Specific Ask	"We would be grateful for guidance on: 1) Upcoming JETRO events (JPCC, Comic Con Africa) that we should attend; 2) Potential introductions to Japanese studios interested in African partnerships; 3) Any advice on approaching Japanese creative companies as a community organisation."
Appreciation	Acknowledge their proven success in this space

END OF JAPAN OUTREACH EMAIL TEMPLATE
